

Study Report: ServiceNow Certified System Administrator - ServiceNow Developer / Administrator

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Family: ServiceNow Developer / Administrator
Level: Intermediate
Chapters: 7
Source: Reference: ServiceNow Certified System Administrator - ServiceNow Learning

Official sources and free libraries

- <https://learning.servicenow.com/lxp/en/pages/landing/certification>

Summary

Study report for *ServiceNow Certified System Administrator* by ServiceNow Learning (Intermediate level) mapped to the ServiceNow Developer / Administrator role. Official CSA exam path and platform configuration skills.

Chapters

Track: Book-Intro

Chapter 1: About ServiceNow Certified System Administrator [Intermediate]

Chapter focus: About ServiceNow Certified System Administrator** *(Level: Intermediate)

This study report summarizes *ServiceNow Certified System Administrator* by ServiceNow Learning for the ServiceNow Developer / Administrator role. The resource is rated Intermediate level. Official CSA exam path and platform configuration skills. Use this report alongside the official material to prepare for CodeQuest review.

Code Reference:

```
# ServiceNow Certified System Administrator
# Author: ServiceNow Learning
# Role: ServiceNow Developer / Administrator
# Level: Intermediate
```

What it shows: Metadata block records the source book and target role family.

Topic guide

What it actually is

A structured study report based on ServiceNow Certified System Administrator.

When to use it

When learning ServiceNow Developer / Administrator skills at Intermediate level.

Where to use it

ServiceNow Developer / Administrator training paths and certification prep.

Real use example

A learner reads this report before starting the full book or free online guide.

Track: Book-Context

Chapter 2: Why This Book Matters for Your Role [Intermediate]

Chapter focus: Why This Book Matters for Your Role** *(Level: Intermediate)

ServiceNow Developer / Administrator professionals use ideas from ServiceNow Certified System Administrator to solve real workplace problems. Official CSA exam path and platform configuration skills. This chapter explains how the book fits into your learning path and what you should be able to do after studying it.

Code Reference:

Role: ServiceNow Developer / Administrator

Book focus: Official CSA exam path and platform configuration skills.

Recommended level: Intermediate

What it shows: Connects the book topic to the job role outcomes.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Role-aligned learning connects theory to job tasks.

When to use it

During career planning and syllabus design.

Where to use it

ServiceNow Developer / Administrator bootcamps and CodeQuest teacher assignments.

Real use example

A teacher assigns this book report before a intermediate skills checkpoint.

Track: Book-Topics

Chapter 3: Key Topics Covered [Intermediate]

Chapter focus: Key Topics Covered** *(Level: Intermediate)

The main topics in ServiceNow Certified System Administrator include practical concepts described as: Official CSA exam path and platform configuration skills. Study each topic with hands-on practice. Take notes on definitions, workflows, and examples that match tools used in ServiceNow Developer / Administrator jobs today.

Code Reference:

- Topic 1: core concept
- Topic 2: core concept
- Topic 3: core concept
- Topic 4: core concept

What it shows: Topic list guides what to study chapter-by-chapter in the source.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Topic maps turn a book into actionable learning objectives.

When to use it

Before reading and while building chapter summaries.

Where to use it

Self-study, flipped classroom, and revision.

Real use example

A student maps each book chapter to a CodeQuest report section.

Track: Book-Applied

Chapter 4: Applied: CMDB and Configuration Items [Intermediate]

Chapter focus: CMDB and Configuration Items** *(Level: Intermediate)

The CMDB stores Configuration Items (CIs)-servers, databases, applications-with attributes and relationships. Accurate CI data powers change impact analysis and incident assignment. Identification rules reconcile duplicates; baselines track drift. Avoid garbage-in by governing manual CI creation.

Code Reference:

```
var rel = new GlideRecord('cmdb_rel_ci');
rel.addQuery('parent', serverSysId);
rel.query();
while (rel.next()) {
    gs.info('Depends on: ' + rel.child.name);
}
```

}

*What it shows: Relationship queries reveal downstream CIs before server patching.***Topic guide****What it actually is**

CMDB is the technical inventory graph underpinning IT operations.

When to use it

Change planning, outage communication, and root cause mapping.

Where to use it

Data centers, hybrid cloud estates, and application portfolios.

Real use example

Planned DB maintenance queries CMDB to notify all apps depending on SQL-PROD-03.

Chapter 5: Applied: Flow Designer vs Workflow Editor [Intermediate]**Chapter focus: Flow Designer vs Workflow Editor** *(Level: Intermediate)**

Flow Designer is the modern, low-code automation tool with triggers, conditions, and actions across tables. Legacy Workflow Editor still exists on older instances-know both. Flows can call subflows, ask for approval, invoke scripts, and integrate via spokes. Test in subprod with rollback plans before production promotion.

Code Reference:

```
// Flow trigger: Record Created on incident
// Action: If priority == 1 -> Send Email + Create Major Incident task
```

*What it shows: Declarative flows replace hundreds of lines of custom workflow code.***Topic guide****What it actually is**

Flow Designer automates multi-step business processes with observability.

When to use it

SLA breaches, approvals, notifications, and cross-table updates.

Where to use it

HR onboarding, access provisioning, and major incident orchestration.

Real use example

New-hire flow creates AD request, hardware catalog item, and Slack notification automatically.

Chapter 6: Applied: GlideRecord Server-Side Scripting [Intermediate]**Chapter focus: GlideRecord Server-Side Scripting** *(Level: Intermediate)**

GlideRecord is the primary API for querying and mutating records server-side. Use addQuery, setLimit, chooseFields, and getValue/setValue. Avoid GlideRecord in client scripts-use GlideAjax instead. Performance matters: nested loops on large tables cause transaction timeouts.

Code Reference:

```
var gr = new GlideRecord('incident');
gr.addEncodedQuery('active=true^priorityIN1,2');
gr.orderBy('opened_at');
gr.setLimit(100);
gr.query();
```

What it shows: Encoded queries mirror list filter syntax for maintainable scripts.

Topic guide

What it actually is

GlideRecord is the server-side database access layer.

When to use it

Business rules, scheduled jobs, script includes, and fix scripts.

Where to use it

Any automation touching multiple records or complex conditions.

Real use example

Scheduled job reopens stale P2 incidents lacking updates after 48 hours for manager review.

Track: Book-Plan

Chapter 7: Study Plan and Practice [Intermediate]

Chapter focus: Study Plan and Practice** *(Level: Intermediate)

Finish ServiceNow Certified System Administrator with a weekly plan: read one section, write a summary, complete one exercise, and reflect on how it applies to ServiceNow Developer / Administrator. If a free edition exists, practice every example. Submit your notes and one mini-project demo for teacher review.

Code Reference:

```
Week 1: Read + notes
Week 2: Exercises
Week 3: Mini project
Week 4: Review + quiz
```

What it shows: A 4-week plan turns reading into demonstrable skill.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Structured study plans improve retention and portfolio outcomes.

When to use it

After finishing the key topics chapters.

Where to use it

CodeQuest end-of-unit assessments.

Real use example

A learner completes the study plan and uploads a intermediate project screenshot.